

10. SELF RELIANCE

EXERCISE 1- SUMMARY

"Self-Reliance" is an essay by Ralph Waldo Emerson which explores the values of transcendentalism. Emerson explains to the reader that true direct knowledge can only come from within. Any knowledge that a person learns from another person or a book is not true knowledge. The more people use their intuition and believe in themselves, the better society will be. According to author, self-reliance makes a man great. The power is within the man. One should peep into one's insight in order to know the power of one's life. When a person does not value own qualities, he will not live a satisfying or gratifying life. Tomorrow a stranger will say masterly good sense precisely what he has thought and felt all the time, and he shall be forced to take with shame his own opinion from another. A person can be happy when he puts his heart and soul to his work and done his best. According to author, Ralph Waldo Emerson. **"Happiness is a perfume you cannot pour on others without getting some on yourself."**

EXERCISE 2- POST READING

Q.1: What makes a man great according to author?

Answer: According to author, self-reliance makes a man great. The power is within the man. One should peep into one's insight in order to know the power of one's life. He should never underestimate himself at all as Shakespeare asserts "Our doubts are traitors and make us lose the good we oft might win by fearing to attempt."

Q.2: Why is self-reliance important for one's development?

Answer: Having self-reliance is important for several reasons. Self-reliance is also important because it:

- Means you can solve problems and make decisions by yourself. This is critical as we grow older and learn to live independently;
- Allows you to feel happy by yourself, in yourself, and about yourself—without needing to rely on others;
- Involves developing self-acceptance, a very powerful thing to have;
- Involves acquiring self-knowledge and practicing self-compassion;
- Gives your perspective, which in turn...
- Gives you direction.

Q.3: What is the mark of genius according to Emerson?

Answer: At thirty-nine, Emerson writes: To believe your own thought, to believe that what is true for you in your private heart is true for all men, — that is genius. He is of the view that who believes in himself is successful. The one who underestimates loses ultimately.

Q.4: What happens when a person doesn't value one's own qualities?

Answer: When a person does not value own qualities, he will not live a satisfying or gratifying life. Tomorrow a stranger will say masterly good sense precisely what he has thought and felt all the time, and he shall be forced to take with shame his own opinion from another.

Q.5: Why does the author emphasizing on developing one's own individuality?

Answer: Emerson explains the ultimate form of happiness is achieved when a person learns and adapts an individualistic lifestyle based on their own values. Emerson emphasizes, "Nothing can bring you peace but yourself."

Q.6: How can a person be happy according to the author?

Answer: A person can be happy when he puts his heart and soul to his work and done his best. According to author, Ralph Waldo Emerson. "Happiness is a perfume you cannot pour on others without getting some on yourself."

Q.7: "What I must do is all that concerns me, not what the people think." Do you agree to this statement? Give reasons for your agreement or disagreement?

Answer: I agree with this statement as this rule, equally arduous in actual and in intellectual life, may serve for the whole distinction between greatness and meanness; but the great man is he who in the midst of the crowd keeps with perfect sweetness the independence of solitude.

Q.8: What kind of changes does a society undergo according to the author?

Answer: Society never advances. It undergoes continual changes; it is barbarous, it is civilized, it is rich, it is religious, it is scientific; but this change is not for better. It acquires one thing, while lost the old thing. It makes people civilized while it keeps away the man from crude nature.

Q.9: How do you relate the message to your life?

Answer: I can relate the message of author to my life by avoiding conformity and false consistency, and follow my own instincts and ideas because whenever we listen other we face problems.